WEEK 2 · STARTER KIT

Starter Kit

Four files that give you a working specification and a running mock server before you write a line of your own.

COURSE	Platform-Based Software Engineering
MEETING	2 · Contract-First Specification
READING	Handbook, Chapter 2
DUE	Before Meeting 3 starts

Starter Kit — Read Me First

Six files. Copy them into the `spec/` folder of your GitHub repository — the one you made in Worksheet W0 — and work from there.

File	What it is
`openapi.starter.yaml`	A working skeleton that already passes the checker. Rename it to `openapi.yaml`. Every `TODO` is yours to replace
`redocly.yaml`	Settings for the checker. Three checks are switched off, each with a note saying when it comes back
`package.json`	The tools, at fixed versions, plus the three commands you need
`examples.sh` / `examples.ps1`	The Step 9 test calls, ready to run
`body.json`	The request body those scripts send. Edit this, not the scripts

Setup

Copy all six files from this folder into a new `spec` folder inside your own working folder. Drag them across in File Explorer, or use the terminal — replacing the first line with wherever your pack actually is:

```
STARTER=~/Downloads/"Week 2 - Home Study Pack"/starter

cd pbse-week2-<your-name>
mkdir -p spec && cd spec
cp "$STARTER"/openapi.starter.yaml ./openapi.yaml
cp "$STARTER"/redocly.yaml "$STARTER"/package.json "$STARTER"/body.json ./
cp "$STARTER"/examples.* ./
npm install
```

The quotation marks matter: the folder name has spaces in it.

Then, in this order:

```
npm run lint     # must print: Woohoo! Your API description is valid.
npm run docs     # writes docs.html - open it in your browser
npm run mock     # starts the fake server at http://127.0.0.1:4010
```

With the mock running, open a **second terminal**:

```
bash examples.sh          # macOS, Linux, Git Bash, WSL
./examples.ps1            # Windows PowerShell
```

What you should see

This skeleton was checked and tested before it was given to you. If `npm run lint` fails on the **unchanged** file, the problem is your installation, not the file. Fix that before you change anything.

The four calls in `examples.sh` should produce:

```
1. GET  /things   -> 200, one thing plus a nextCursor
2. POST /things   -> 201, a thing, with a Location header
3. POST /things   -> 201 again (see the note below)
4. POST /things   -> 422, because you left out the required
   (no key)          Idempotency-Key header
```

If `npm run mock` says `EADDRINUSE: address already in use`, you already have a mock running in another window. Use that one, or stop it with `Ctrl+C` first.

Call 4 is the point of the whole meeting. Your document refused a request, and you have not written a single line of program code. Capture it.

Call 3 is worth understanding too. You sent the **same key twice** and got two different things. That is correct behaviour for a mock: it has no memory of keys. The mock proves your **contract**, not your **behaviour**. Making the second call replay the first is what you build in Meeting 3.

Two notes about the tools

The mock server is pinned to version 5.15.11 on purpose. The newest version needs Node 24.18 or later, which not everybody has. If you are on Node 24.18+ and want the newest, that is fine — but change it for your whole team at the same time. A specification that behaves differently on four laptops is worse than one that behaves slightly worse on all four.

Nothing here is a real server. `prism` reads your YAML file and replies with your own examples. There is no database, no framework, no deployment. If you find yourself installing one this week, stop and reread the first page of Chapter 2.

Do not commit `node_modules`

If you chose the **Node** `.gitignore` when creating your repository, this is already handled. If not, add these three lines to `.gitignore`:

```
node_modules/
.env
*.log
```

`node_modules` is thousands of files that anyone can rebuild with `npm install`. Committing it makes your repository enormous and tells me you did not check what you were pushing.